EMERGENCY **911**

ROADSIDE HELP

ASK THE BEAR

Scan for help any time you have signal.

BEAR WITH ME
The Ready Kit · Life happens.

This booklet gives general guidance. Your owner's manual and a qualified mechanic have the final word.

BEAR WITH ME

THE READY KIT

Life happens.
Let's figure it out.



ASK THE BEAR



When the book isn't enough, I'm in your phone too.

Scan to snap a photo or tell me what's happening. We'll work out your next step together.

Won't scan? Go to **jessboydd.github.io/bear-with-me**

What I can do → p. 19

ROADSIDE HELP PHONE

ASK THE BEAR

START HERE

Take a breath. You've got a plan.

A light came on p. 4

Time for a check
Tires, oil
p. 13

Not sure what's going on
Ask the bear
p. 18

In danger, smoke or a crash? Get safe and call 911.

MY CAR'S NUMBERS

Fill this in now, while things are calm. Future you says thanks.

CAR · YEAR, MAKE, MODEL

_____

TIRE PRESSURE · DRIVER'S DOOR STICKER

Front _____ PSI Rear _____ PSI

Spare _____ PSI

Has ☐ spare ☐ inflator kit ☐ neither

OIL · OWNER'S MANUAL

Type _____ e.g. 0W-20

Check it ☐ warm ☐ cold

ROADSIDE HELP · PHONE

_____

Via ☐ insurance ☐ car maker ☐ other

INSURANCE

Company _____

Card in ☐ my kit ☐ glove box ☐ my phone

Tire number: driver's door sticker → p. 13

WHAT I CAN AND CAN'T DO

I CAN

- Explain what you're seeing
- Walk you through checks
- Tell you when to call for help

I CAN'T

- Know your car's exact specs
- Replace your manual or a mechanic
- Work without signal

No signal? This booklet works anywhere.

Back to scanning → p. 18

SECTION 1 · DASHBOARD LIGHTS

WHAT'S THAT LIGHT?

The color is your first clue.

RED · STOP SOON

Pull over when it's safe.

→ **pp. 5–7**

AMBER · CHECK SOON

Get it looked at soon. A few still mean stop: look for the red **STOP**.

→ **pp. 7–10**

GREEN OR BLUE · FYI

Something is on. Nothing is wrong.

→ **p. 11**

TRIANGLE !

Read the message on your screen. It says Stop? Stop.

Flashing is more urgent than steady.

BASIC CHECKS · OIL

READ THE DIPSTICK

1. Pull it out and wipe it clean.
2. Push it all the way back in, then pull it out again.
3. Look where the oil line sits.



Between the two marks: you're good.

Below or near the low mark: add a little of the oil type on p. 2, wait, check again. Don't overfill.

- **Milky, foamy or gritty:** don't add oil. Have a mechanic look.

Dark brown or black: it may be time for an oil change. Check your service schedule.

Still unsure? Ask the bear → p. 18

BASIC CHECKS · OIL

OIL'S WELL THAT ENDS WELL

Once a month, or before a long drive

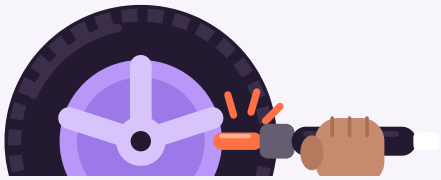


- Park on **flat ground** and turn the engine off.
- **Warm or cold?** Your manual says. If warm, wait 5+ minutes after turning it off.
- Open the hood. Find the **dipstick**: usually a bright yellow or orange loop.

Engine parts get hot. Keep hands, hair and sleeves clear.

TIRES · HOW TO CHECK

CHECK IT



1. **Check when tires are cold:** before driving, or after sitting a few hours.
2. Unscrew the valve cap. Keep it somewhere safe.
3. Press the gauge straight onto the valve until the hissing stops.
4. Read the number.
5. Screw the cap back on. Repeat on all four tires.

Once a month, check all four, and the spare too.

STOP SOON

Pull over when it's safe. Don't keep driving.

OIL PRESSURE

Your engine may not be getting enough oil. Pull over and turn the engine off. Call for help.

May show as a message: **Oil Pressure Low**

ENGINE TEMPERATURE

Your engine is overheating. Pull over, turn off the A/C, then the engine. Steam? Wait to open the hood. **Never open the radiator or coolant cap while hot.** Call for help.

May show as a message: **Engine Coolant Temp High**

STOP SOON

POWER STEERING

Steering may suddenly feel very heavy. **Hold the wheel firmly,** pull over when it's safe and call for help.

CHECK SOON

CHECK ENGINE

Get it checked right away. Many auto parts stores read the code for free. First: gas cap loose? Tighten until it clicks. Tank empty? Fill up.

- **Flashing:** treat it like a red light.

STOP SOON

BATTERY / CHARGING

The car isn't charging and may stop running. **Pull over when it's safe and call for help.** Driving on may be dangerous.

May show as a message: **Charging System Malfunction**

BRAKE WARNING

BRAKE

First, make sure the parking brake is fully off. Still on? Your brakes may need attention. Pull over carefully and call for help.

Some cars show **(!)** in a circle instead of the word.

How to pull over safely → p. 12

CHECK SOON

LOW TIRE PRESSURE

One or more tires is low.

Stop: pull over somewhere safe soon and check all four → p. 13. Avoid hard braking and sharp turns.

Flashed first, then stayed on? The sensor needs a shop. Cold mornings can set it off.

ABS · ANTI-LOCK BRAKES

ABS

The anti-lock brake system has a problem.

Stop: pull over when it's safe and call for help. Driving on may be dangerous.

More amber lights → p. 9

WHAT YOUR NUMBER MEANS

Below your number: add air. Use a gas station air pump. Add a little, check, repeat.

Right at your number: you're done. Nice work.

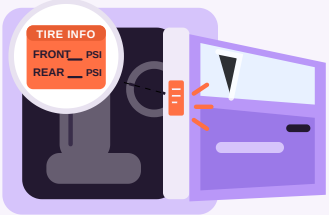
Above it: let a little air out by pressing the small pin in the valve (many gauges have a nub for this), then check again.

Way low, or a tire looks flat? Don't drive on it. Use your spare or inflator kit, or call for help. Small spare on? The tire light may stay on.

Still unsure? Ask the bear → p. 18

TIRE TALK

Every car has its own number. It's in PSI (pounds per square inch).



LOOK HERE: INSIDE THE DRIVER'S DOOR

Use the number ending in **PSI** under **Cold tire pressure**. The spare may differ.

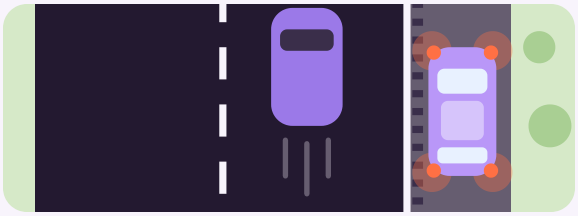
Not the tire. The number printed on the tire is its *maximum*, not your target.

Write it on p. 2 so you only look once.

Next: check it → p. 14

DASHBOARD LIGHTS

PULL OVER, THEN READ ON



1. **Signal and slow down.** Move as far from traffic as you can.
2. **Turn on your hazard lights.**
3. **Put the car in park** and turn the engine off.
4. **On a busy road, staying buckled in is often safest.** If you get out, use the side away from traffic.
5. **Call roadside help** (your number is on p. 2), or **911** if you're in danger.

Still unsure? Ask the bear → p. 18

⚠ CHECK SOON

TRACTION / STABILITY

Flashing: it's working right now, usually on a slippery road. Ease off the gas.

Stays on: it needs a shop.

AIRBAG (SRS)

Red or amber, depending on the car. Your airbags may not work in a crash. **Get it checked right away.**

More amber lights → p. 10

CHECK SOON

LOW FUEL

Time to fill up. How far you can go on the light varies by car, so don't count on it.

SERVICE REMINDER

An oil change or service is due. Not an emergency: book it soon.

May show a wrench, or a message like **Maintenance Required Soon**.

Red oil can instead? That's oil pressure: stop → p. 5.

Just so you know → p. 11

JUST SO YOU KNOW

HIGH BEAMS

Your brights are on. Switch them off for oncoming cars or when following someone.

OFTEN RED, BUT JUST A REMINDER

Seatbelt: buckle up (and your passengers). A bag on the front seat can set it off.

Door open: a door or the trunk isn't fully shut. Some cars show a picture of the car instead.

DON'T SEE YOUR LIGHT?

It's in your owner's manual. Or ask me → p. 18.



Need to pull over? → p. 12